from apartheid (especially the migrant labour system, which was responsible for super-profits) were immoral, that the taxes they paid to Pretoria kept the oppression going, and that even though the firms' South African workers would be adversely affected by BDS, those workers and their organisations mainly supported this non-violent strategy. By the mid-1980s when anti-apartheid BDS peaked, by all accounts it contributed substantially to South Africa's 1985 economic crash, and the campaign kept up pressure until finally it was possible to declare an irreversible victory: the 'one-person one-vote in a unitary state' election on 27 April 1994.

In turn, such memories renew our confidence in international solidarity, especially when BDS is being applied today to Israel (in this case supported by the South African government due to historical relations with the Palestinian Liberation Organisation) and fossil fuel corporations with repeated reference to South African victories. South Africa also has hosted extensive civil society campaigning on behalf of Zimbabweans, Swazis, Tibetans and Burmese struggling for liberation, although rising xenophobia in 2015 reversed all that solidarity work. The global 'Climate Justice' movement sees South Africa as a key site, dating to the 2002 World Summit on Sustainable Development and the 2011 UN Climate Summit. A variety of other global justice projects, especially for access to AIDS medicines and the fight against water privatisation and carbon trading, have had critical groundings in South Africa.

All of these provide varieties of experience for international solidarity – but not yet the coherent overarching internationalist commitments and post-capitalist, anti-racist, feminist and ecological strategies needed for the complex times ahead. BRICS offers one site to compare analysis, strategies, tactics and alliances for what might become a crucial corrective to destructive tendencies by these countries' corporations, as they take the baton from Western multinational corporations, both within the BRICS and across the hinterlands. In this extraordinary context, we academic critics are hoping to open up two crucial debates: first, is BRICS anti-imperialist as advertised, or potentially inter-imperialist as the Ukraine battleground portends, or merely sub-imperialist where it counts most: in the ongoing global financial and climate meltdowns? Second, if the latter (as most of our authors agree), how can the struggles of BRICS from below intensify and link? The detox of our corrupted politics, a sober reassessment of our economies and fortification of our ecologies – all catalysed by re-energised civil societies – rely upon clear, confident answers to both.